

Wendeline Hartwell

Character Dossier

Meticulous and easily flustered cartographer of Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity

Overview

Wendeline Hartwell is a cartographer living in Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity. Wendeline is 77 years old, originally from Kettering, and is known around the Undermarket as meticulous and easily flustered. In conversation Wendeline tells long stories that circle back to the point eventually.

Background

Wendeline arrived in Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity 10 years ago after leaving Kettering under circumstances Wendeline describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Halcyon Syndicate; the second was the one that stuck. Today Wendeline works as a cartographer near Sector 9 transit hub and is paid, when paid at all, in meridian scrip.

Wendeline learned the trade from Percival Norwood, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Wendeline's life is with Jasper Quenneville, over a matter neither will explain. The person Wendeline trusts most is Lucienne Brightmoor.

Current goal: to find out what happened to the missing caravan. Greatest fear: birds indoors.

Personality and speech

Temperament: meticulous and easily flustered.

Speech pattern: Wendeline tells long stories that circle back to the point eventually.

Tells: when lying, Wendeline mentions Sprocket the lizard for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Wendeline Hartwell
Role	cartographer
Home	Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity
Hometown	Kettering
Age	77
Favourite dish	festival saffron rice
Pet	Sprocket, a lizard
Lucky number	645

<i>Workshop password</i>	granite-pepper
<i>Mentor</i>	Percival Norwood
<i>Rival</i>	Jasper Quenneville
<i>Closest friend</i>	Lucienne Brightmoor

Secret

Wendeline cannot actually read the old script everyone assumes they can, and has memorised the important pages.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Wendeline: I am the cartographer. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Wendeline: Festival saffron rice. Do not tell Jasper I said so.

Visitor: Is Sprocket yours?

Wendeline: Sprocket belongs to nobody. Sprocket tolerates me. Lucky number is 645, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, spring of year 21

A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Wendeline and Jasper outside the flooded lower rings; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Someone left a cracked compass on the doorstep with no note. Wendeline suspects Lucienne and is probably right. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Wendeline and Jasper outside the flooded lower rings; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A dispute over the quarantine flared up between Wendeline and Jasper outside the flooded lower rings; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 2, winter of year 21

Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Wendeline suspects Lucienne and is probably right. Rumours about the census reached the flooded lower rings. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Wendeline and Jasper outside the flooded lower rings; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 3, spring of year 21

the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the quarantine. Wendeline read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Wendeline and Jasper outside Sector 9 transit hub; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Wendeline for the password to the workshop. Wendeline laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 4, spring of year 21

Someone left a clockwork bird on the doorstep with no note. Wendeline suspects Lucienne and is probably right. Wendeline found a wax seal half-buried near Kowloon Arcade and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Someone left a sextant on the doorstep with no note. Wendeline suspects Lucienne and is probably right. The weather turned. Wendeline moved the signal flag indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Percival about the rumour of a second well.

Entry 5, spring of year 21

At the Undermarket, Wendeline taught Lucienne how to tell a real oilskin map from a fake one by weight alone. Percival visited unannounced. They argued about whether the bridge will hold for an hour and parted better friends than before. Wendeline closed early, walked to the flooded lower rings, and watched the lights come on. Sprocket followed at a distance. Wren came by asking about who really won the regatta. Wendeline said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 6, autumn of year 21

Wendeline was hired to carry a tin whistle from the flooded lower rings to Kowloon Arcade without opening it, and mostly succeeded. The weather turned. Wendeline moved the wax seal indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Percival about the old tunnels. Wendeline won 84 meridian scrip from Jasper on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on festival saffron rice.

Wendeline was hired to carry a coil of rope from the flooded lower rings to Kowloon Arcade without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 7, spring of year 21

At the Undermarket, Wendeline taught Lucienne how to tell a real spool of wire from a fake one by weight alone. The weather turned. Wendeline moved the spool of wire indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Percival about the census. Wendeline spent the day counting stock at the Undermarket: 74 of everything, except the signal flag, which is always short. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the missing shipment. Wendeline read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 8, summer of year 21

Wendeline won 10 meridian scrip from Jasper on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on festival saffron rice. Wendeline spent the day counting stock at the Undermarket: 80 of everything, except the tin whistle, which is always short. At the Undermarket, Wendeline taught Lucienne how to tell a real brass lantern from a fake one by weight alone. Wendeline closed early, walked to the Glass District, and watched the lights come on. Sprocket followed at a distance.

Entry 9, spring of year 22

Percival visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. Wendeline repaired the pair of spectacles at the flooded lower rings for Zubair, who paid in 88 meridian scrip and a long story about the right way to mend a net. Wendeline closed early, walked to Sector 9 transit hub, and watched the lights come on. Sprocket followed at a distance. Wendeline spent the day counting stock at the flooded lower rings: 44 of everything, except the wax seal, which is always short. Rumours about the old tunnels reached the flooded lower rings. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 10, summer of year 22

The weather turned. Wendeline moved the sack of salt indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Percival about the census. Wendeline was hired to carry a signal flag from Kowloon Arcade to the Undermarket without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Wendeline for the password to the workshop. Wendeline laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 11, autumn of year 22

Wendeline closed early, walked to Sector 9 transit hub, and watched the lights come on. Sprocket followed at a distance. The weather turned. Wendeline moved the signal flag indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Percival about the right way to mend a net. Qadira came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Wendeline said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 12, summer of year 22

Wendeline closed early, walked to Sector 9 transit hub, and watched the lights come on. Sprocket followed at a distance. Percival visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the census. Wendeline read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Someone left a iron kettle on the doorstep with no note. Wendeline suspects Lucienne and is probably right.

Entry 13, summer of year 22

the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Wendeline read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Wendeline spent the day counting stock at the Undermarket: 41 of everything, except the sack of salt, which is always short. Rumours about the price of lamp oil reached the Undermarket. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. At the Undermarket, Wendeline taught Lucienne how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. The weather turned. Wendeline moved the hand bell indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Percival about the right way to mend a net.

Entry 14, spring of year 22

Wendeline spent the day counting stock at Kowloon Arcade: 59 of everything, except the sextant, which is always short. The weather turned. Wendeline moved the iron kettle indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Percival about the quarantine. Farida came by asking about who really won the regatta. Wendeline said nothing useful and made tea instead. Wendeline repaired the signal flag at Kowloon Arcade for Xanthe, who paid in 14 meridian scrip and a long story about the new curfew.

Entry 15, spring of year 22

Wendeline repaired the coil of rope at the flooded lower rings for Zora, who paid in 62 meridian scrip and a long story about who really won the regatta. At the flooded lower rings, Wendeline taught Lucienne how to tell a real spool of wire from a fake one by weight alone. Wendeline closed early, walked to Kowloon Arcade, and watched the lights come on. Sprocket followed at a distance. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Wendeline and Jasper outside the flooded lower rings; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 16, spring of year 22

The weather turned. Wendeline moved the cracked compass indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Percival about the right way to mend a net. A dispute over the comet flared up between Wendeline and Jasper outside the flooded lower rings; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Wendeline read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Someone left a copper pipe on the doorstep with no note. Wendeline suspects Lucienne and is probably right. Wendeline was hired to carry a hand bell from the flooded lower rings to the Undermarket without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 17, spring of year 22

Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the flooded lower rings. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. The weather turned. Wendeline moved the bolt of linen indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Percival about the tariff on salt. The weather turned. Wendeline moved the cracked compass indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Percival about the rumour of a second well. Wendeline spent the day counting stock at the flooded lower rings: 67 of everything, except the grain scale, which is always short.

Entry 18, winter of year 22

Percival visited unannounced. They argued about the new curfew for an hour and parted better friends than before. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Wendeline suspects Lucienne and is probably right. Wendeline repaired the spool of wire at the Glass District for Freya, who paid in 61 meridian scrip and a long story about the right way to mend a net.

Entry 19, summer of year 22

Wendeline repaired the cracked compass at Kowloon Arcade for Corvina, who paid in 37 meridian scrip and a long story about the rumour of a second well. Wendeline was hired to carry a brass lantern from Kowloon Arcade to the Undermarket without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Wendeline found a bundle of letters half-buried near Kowloon Arcade and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 20, autumn of year 22

Percival visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. Wendeline repaired the pair of spectacles at the Undermarket for Nkechi, who paid in 16 meridian scrip and a long story about the tariff on salt. At the Undermarket, Wendeline taught Lucienne how to tell a real signal flag from a fake one by weight alone. Rumours about the harvest count reached the Undermarket. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. At the Undermarket, Wendeline taught Lucienne how to tell a real spool of wire from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 21, spring of year 22

Wendeline won 14 meridian scrip from Jasper on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on festival saffron rice. Rumours about the census reached the Glass District. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Wendeline and Jasper outside the Glass District; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Wendeline was hired to carry a coil of rope from the Glass District to the Undermarket without opening it, and mostly succeeded. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Wendeline read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 22, autumn of year 22

At Kowloon Arcade, Wendeline taught Lucienne how to tell a real iron kettle from a fake one by weight alone. Percival visited unannounced. They argued about the new curfew for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached Kowloon Arcade. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 23, winter of year 22

Wendeline repaired the hand bell at the Undermarket for Tomasz, who paid in 50 meridian scrip and a long story about the missing shipment. Someone left a pair of spectacles on the doorstep with no note. Wendeline suspects Lucienne and is probably right. The weather turned. Wendeline moved the grain scale indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Percival about the quarantine.

Entry 24, spring of year 22

Wendeline spent the day counting stock at the Undermarket: 38 of everything, except the glass float, which is always short. At the Undermarket, Wendeline taught Lucienne how to tell a real sack of salt from a fake one by weight alone. Wendeline won 32 meridian scrip from Jasper on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on festival saffron rice.

Entry 25, summer of year 23

The weather turned. Wendeline moved the sack of salt indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Percival about whether the bridge will hold. Rumours about the census reached Kowloon Arcade. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about the census reached Kowloon Arcade. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Wendeline read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Wendeline repaired the clockwork bird at Kowloon Arcade for Xanthe, who paid in 27 meridian scrip and a long story about the old tunnels.

Entry 26, summer of year 23

A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Wendeline and Jasper outside the Glass District; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rumours about the price of lamp oil reached the Glass District. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about the comet reached the Glass District. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the quarantine. Wendeline read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Wendeline repaired the hand bell at the Glass District for Quentin, who paid in 24 meridian scrip and a long story about the tariff on salt.

Entry 27, spring of year 23

Wendeline won 55 meridian scrip from Jasper on a bet about whether the bridge will hold and spent all of it on festival saffron rice. Someone left a grain scale on the doorstep with no note. Wendeline suspects Lucienne and is probably right. Rumours about the new curfew reached Sector 9 transit hub. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. At Sector 9 transit hub, Wendeline taught Lucienne how to tell a real hand bell from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 28, spring of year 23

The weather turned. Wendeline moved the grain scale indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Percival about the rumour of a second well. Liora came by asking about the quarantine. Wendeline said nothing useful and made tea instead. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the singing at the docks. Wendeline read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A dispute over the quarantine flared up between Wendeline and Jasper outside Sector 9 transit hub; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 29, summer of year 24

Wendeline found a brass lantern half-buried near the flooded lower rings and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Delphine came by asking about the right way to mend a net. Wendeline said nothing useful and made tea instead. Rumours about the new curfew reached the flooded lower rings. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about the tariff on salt reached the flooded lower rings. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 30, summer of year 24

Wendeline was hired to carry a coil of rope from the Glass District to the Undermarket without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Wendeline closed early, walked to the Undermarket, and watched the lights come on. Sprocket followed at a distance. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the quarantine. Wendeline read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the harvest count. Wendeline read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rumours about the tax on doors reached the Glass District. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 31, winter of year 24

Wendeline was hired to carry a sextant from the Glass District to the Undermarket without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Wendeline won 72 meridian scrip from Jasper on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on festival saffron rice. Wendeline found a spool of wire half-buried near the Glass District and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Wendeline repaired the coil of rope at the Glass District for Yevgenia, who paid in 21 meridian scrip and a long story about the old tunnels.

Entry 32, autumn of year 24

Kenji came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Wendeline said nothing useful and made tea instead. The weather turned. Wendeline moved the iron kettle indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Percival about the harvest count. Wendeline repaired the ledger at Kowloon Arcade for Rosalind, who paid in 5 meridian scrip and a long story about the singing at the docks. Wendeline found a hand bell half-buried near Kowloon Arcade and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Wendeline won 28 meridian scrip from Jasper on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on festival saffron rice.

Entry 33, winter of year 24

Vesna came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Wendeline said nothing useful and made tea instead. Wendeline spent the day counting stock at the Undermarket: 27 of everything, except the bolt of linen, which is always short. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the Undermarket. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. The weather turned. Wendeline moved the clockwork bird indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Percival about whether the bridge will hold. Rumours about the tariff on salt reached the Undermarket. Wendeline pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 34, summer of year 24

At Sector 9 transit hub, Wendeline taught Lucienne how to tell a real clockwork bird from a fake one by weight alone. Wendeline closed early, walked to the flooded lower rings, and watched the lights come on. Sprocket followed at a distance. Wendeline was hired to carry a copper pipe from Sector 9 transit hub to the flooded lower rings without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 35, summer of year 24

A dispute over the census flared up between Wendeline and Jasper outside Kowloon Arcade; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Wendeline spent the day counting stock at Kowloon Arcade:

8 of everything, except the signal flag, which is always short. Someone left a oilskin map on the doorstep with no note. Wendeline suspects Lucienne and is probably right. Wendeline repaired the bolt of linen at Kowloon Arcade for Oduya, who paid in 13 meridian scrip and a long story about the right way to mend a net.

Entry 36, spring of year 24

Nadira came by asking about the comet. Wendeline said nothing useful and made tea instead. Caspian came by asking about the missing shipment. Wendeline said nothing useful and made tea instead. Wendeline won 10 meridian scrip from Jasper on a bet about the old tunnels and spent all of it on festival saffron rice. Wendeline repaired the ledger at the flooded lower rings for Valentin, who paid in 40 meridian scrip and a long story about the old tunnels. Percival visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 37, autumn of year 24

Percival visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. Wendeline spent the day counting stock at the flooded lower rings: 72 of everything, except the oilskin map, which is always short. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the harvest count. Wendeline read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.